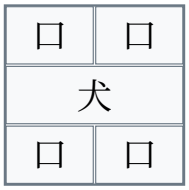
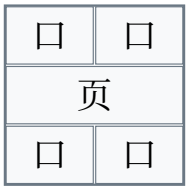
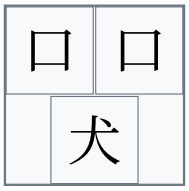
	Oracle bone	Bronze	Seal	Zi-Matrix
器	–			
囂 (器)	–			
哭	–	–		
喪				not in the database

Figure 1: A dog, or a head, among mouths. 器 (vessel), 囂 (clamour) and 哭 (to cry) all place 口 (mouth) around or above a central part: in 器 the centre is 页 (head), and in 哭 the dog is below two mouths. 喪 (mourning) is shown because Wiktionary lists it as another theory of where 器 comes from. A dash means the source has no form of that kind. In particular it shows *no oracle-bone form of* 器, so the earliest form here is bronze. Glyph images: Wikimedia Commons (public domain), see `CREDITS.md`.

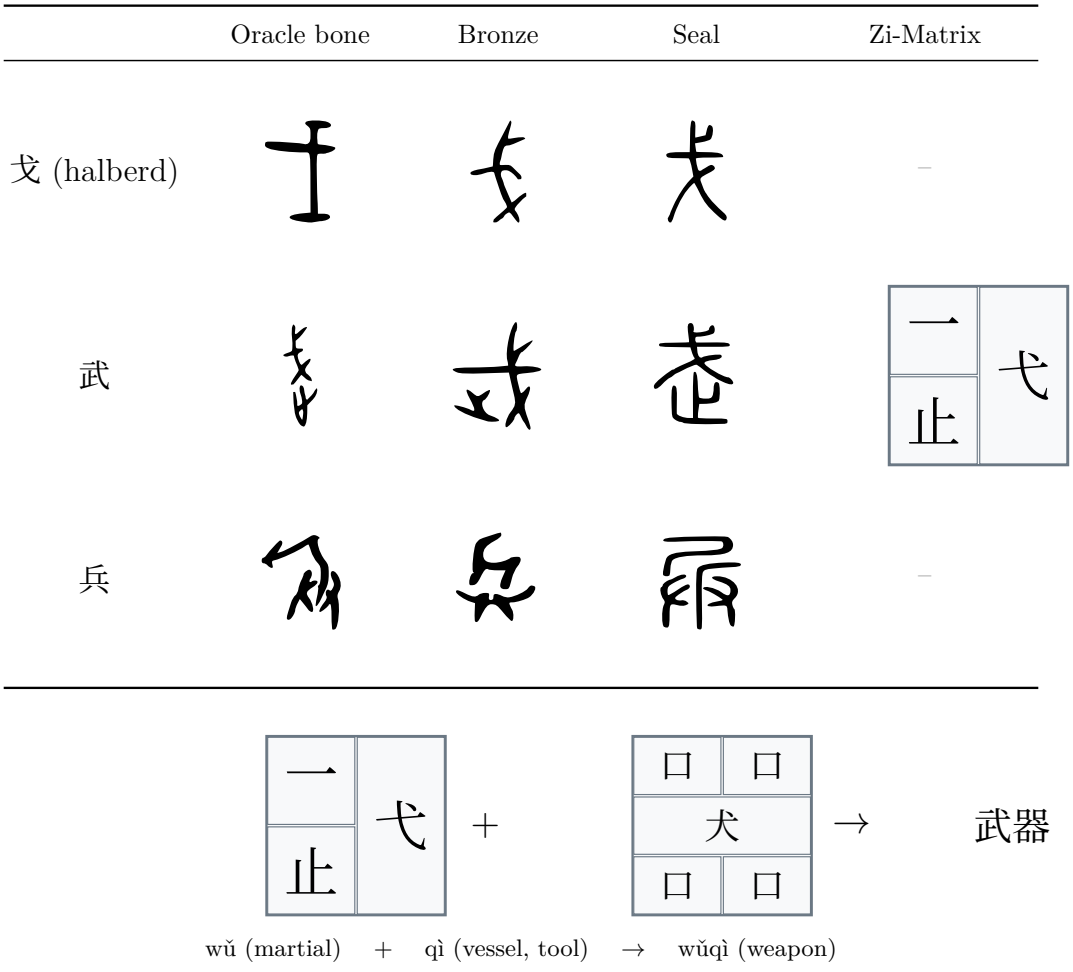


Figure 2: The weapon dimension. The database decomposes 武 as 一, 止 and 弋, and the traditional reading is 止 (foot) and 戈 (halberd). In the word 武器 (weapon), 器 is the generic "implement", as in 兵器 and 利器. If the early picture of 器 is a dog caught among mouths, that could point to a trap as one of the earliest implements of hunting, so that "implement" grew out of "trapping device". This is a hypothesis to test against the early forms and their uses, and not an established etymology.